

you a sort of guide to understanding your own behaviour around money – which will, in turn, give you the key to unlocking a better relationship with your finances.

Financial therapy – a gap in the market?

When our financial past can be so complicated, and so intertwined with our relationships and experiences from a very young age, it makes sense that we might need some help to dissect our feelings about it and move on from any related trauma. Especially because, as is evidenced by almost every person I've spoken to about money, these learned responses, fears, anxieties and coping mechanisms may actually be sabotaging all of our attempts to have a peaceful, controlled and more *neutral* relationship with money in the present. When our judgement is clouded by our complicated feelings about money, it becomes far more difficult to make the informed and positive decisions that will lead us to a better financial future, or even to be able to enjoy the money that we have earned. Financial therapists do, in fact, exist, though they seem to be more established in America than in the UK. The practice couples traditional financial advice with an exploration of the psychological blocks and issues that shape our relationship with money, though the depth of financial advice that therapists, who usually come from a psychology or mental health background, are able to give varies. As an emerging practice, there are obviously wrinkles to be ironed out and